

Critias

KPITIAΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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T: How glad I am, Socrates, to have come to the end of my protracted account. I feel relieved now, as if I were resting after a long journey. And I pray now to the god who has just been created in words, although created long ago in fact, to grant us the preservation of anything reasonable that we have said and to impose justice, as appropriate, if we have unwittingly gone out of tune on these subjects. And right justice means returning to harmony the person who has gone out of tune. Now, so that the remainder of our discourse about the creation of gods may be spoken aright, we pray that we may be given the most perfect and excellent medicine of all medicines, which is knowledge, and with this prayer I entrust the next discourse to Critias, as we agreed.

ΤΙ. ὡς ἄσμενος, ὦ Σώκρατες, οἷον ἐκ μακρᾶς ἀναπεπαυμένος ὁδοῦ, νῦν οὕτως ἐκ τῆς τοῦ λόγου διαπορείας ἀγαπητῶς ἀπήλλαγμαί. τῷ δὲ πρὶν μὲν πάλαι ποτ' ἔργω, νῦν δὲ λόγοις ἄρτι θεῷ γεγονότι προσεύχομαι, τῶν ῥηθέντων ὅσα μὲν ἐρρήθη μετρίως, σωτηρίαν ἡμῖν αὐτὸν αὐτῶν διδόναι, παρὰ μέλος δὲ εἴ τι περὶ αὐτῶν ἄκοντες εἵπομεν, δίκην τὴν πρέπουσαν ἐπιτιθέναι. δίκη δὲ ὀρθὴ τὸν πλημμελοῦντα ἐμμελῆ ποιεῖν· ἴν' οὗν τὸ λοιπὸν τοὺς περὶ θεῶν γενέσεως ὀρθῶς λέγωμεν λόγους, φάρμακον ἡμῖν αὐτὸν τελεώτατον καὶ ἄριστον φαρμάκων ἐπιστήμην εὐχόμεθα διδόναι, προσευξάμενοι δὲ παραδίδομεν κατὰ τὰς ὁμολογίας Κριτία τὸν ἐξῆς λόγον. ΚΡΙ. ἀλλ', ὦ Τίμαιε, δέχομαι μὲν, ὥ δὲ καὶ σὺ κατ'

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C: Indeed, Timaeus, although I accept the task, I request some indulgence just as you did at the very outset, since I am about to speak on such major issues. I am now making the same request, but in view of what I am about to say, I deserve even more indulgence than yourself. And I am quite aware that the request I am about to make is most audacious and more blunt than needs be, but I must make it nevertheless.

ἀρχὰς ἐχρήσω, συγγνώμην αἰτούμενος ὡς περὶ μεγάλων μέλλων λέγειν, ταῦτ' οὖν καὶ νῦν ἐγὼ τοῦτο παραιτοῦμαι,

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C1: Who could reasonably even attempt to deny that everything you have said was good? But I must somehow endeavour to explain that the forthcoming exposition requires still more indulgence because it is more difficult. Indeed, Timaeus, to sound competent whilst speaking to us humans about the gods is easier to achieve than when speaking about mortals to fellow mortals. For the inexperience and downright ignorance of the listeners about the subject in question makes it very easy for anyone who intends to speak about them to such an audience, and when it comes to the gods, we know where we stand. Follow me here so that I may explain what I mean more clearly. Indeed, anything that is said by any of us must presumably be of the nature of an imitation or representation. Let's look at the production of images of divine and human figures by painters, and how easy or difficult it is to convince the viewers that the imitation is good enough. We shall see firstly that in the case of landscapes, mountains, rivers, woods, the heaven in its entirety and whatever resides and moves there, we are satisfied if someone is able to produce an imitation that bears even a slight resemblance to any of these. Furthermore, since our knowledge of things of this sort is inexact, we do not scrutinise or challenge the paintings, but put up with an unclear and deceptive sketch in these cases.

μειζόνως δὲ αὐτοῦ τυχεῖν ἔτι μᾶλλον ἀξιῶ περὶ τῶν μελλόντων ῥηθήσεσθαι. ΚΡΙ. καίτοι σχεδὸν μὲν οἶδα παραίτησιν εὖ μάλα φιλότιμον καὶ τοῦ δέοντος ἀγροικότεραν μέλλων παραιτεῖσθαι, ῥητέον δὲ ὅμως. ὡς μὲν γὰρ οὐκ εὖ τὰ παρὰ σοῦ λεχθέντα εἴρηται, τίς ἂν ἐπιχειρήσειεν ἔμφρων λέγειν; ὅτι δὲ τὰ ῥηθησόμενα πλείονος συγγνώμης δεῖται χαλεπώτερα ὄντα, τοῦτο πειρατέον πῇ διδάξαι. περὶ θεῶν γάρ, ὦ Τίμαιε, λέγοντά τι πρὸς ἀνθρώπους δοκεῖν ἱκανῶς λέγειν ῥᾶον ἢ περὶ θνητῶν πρὸς ἡμᾶς. ἡ γὰρ ἀπειρία καὶ σφόδρα ἄγνοια τῶν ἀκουόντων περὶ ὧν ἂν οὕτως ἔχωσιν πολλὴν εὐπορίαν παρέχεσθον τῷ μέλλοντι

λέγειν τι περὶ αὐτῶν· περὶ δὲ δὴ θεῶν ἴσμεν ὥς ἔχομεν. ἵνα δὲ σαφέστερον ὃ λέγω δηλώσω, τῇδὲ μοι συνεπίσπεσθε. μίμησιν μὲν γὰρ δὴ καὶ ἀπεικασίαν τὰ παρὰ πάντων ἡμῶν ῥηθέντα χρεῶν που γενέσθαι· τὴν δὲ τῶν γραφῶν εἰδωλοποιίαν περὶ τὰ θεῖά τε καὶ τὰ ἀνθρώπινα σώματα γιγνομένην ἴδωμεν ῥαστώνης τε πέρι καὶ χαλεπότητος πρὸς τὸ τοῖς ὀρώσιν δοκεῖν ἀποχρώντως μεμιμηῆσθαι, καὶ κατοψόμεθα ὅτι γῆν μὲν καὶ ὄρη καὶ ποταμούς καὶ ὕλην οὐρανόν τε σύμπαντα καὶ τὰ περὶ αὐτὸν ὄντα καὶ ἰόντα πρῶτον μὲν ἀγαπῶμεν ἂν τίς τι καὶ βραχὺ πρὸς ὁμοιότητα αὐτῶν ἀπομιμεῖσθαι δυνατὸς ᾖ, πρὸς δὲ τούτοις, ἅτε οὐδὲν εἰδότες ἀκριβῆς περὶ τῶν τοιούτων, οὔτε ἐξετάζομεν οὔτε ἐλέγχομεν τὰ γεγραμμένα, σκιαγραφία δὲ ἀσαφεῖ καὶ ἀπατηλῶ χρώμεθα περὶ αὐτά· τὰ δὲ ἡμέτερα ὁπότεν τις ἐπιχειρῇ σώματα ἀπεικάζειν, ὀξέως αἰσθανόμενοι τὸ παραλειπόμενον διὰ τὴν αἰεὶ σύνοικον κατανόησιν χαλεποὶ κριταὶ γιγνόμεθα τῷ μὴ πάσας πάντως τὰς ὁμοιότητας ἀποδιδόντι. ταὐτὸν δὴ καὶ κατὰ τοὺς λόγους ἰδεῖν δεῖ γιγνόμενον, ὅτι τὰ μὲν οὐράνια καὶ θεῖα ἀγαπῶμεν καὶ σμικρῶς εἰκότα λεγόμενα, τὰ δὲ θνητὰ καὶ ἀνθρώπινα ἀκριβῶς ἐξετάζομεν. ἐκ δὲ τοῦ παραχρήμα

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CI: But whenever someone sets about producing a likeness of our own bodies, which we are so accustomed to observing, we quickly spot any deficiency and become harsh critics of anyone who does not present us with a full and complete likeness. Well, we need to observe that the same holds for accounts. In the case of the heavenly and divine, we are satisfied with accounts that are likely, even to a small extent, but when it comes to things mortal and human, we scrutinise the accounts with great precision. So, speaking at the moment, without any preparation, you will have to forgive us if we are unable to present an account that is fitting in every respect. For we need to bear in mind that to produce an acceptable likeness of things mortal is difficult rather than easy. Now, Socrates, I have said all this to remind you of these facts and to request more indulgence, rather than less, for whatever I am about to say. If my request for this favour sounds fair, please be willing to grant it.

νῦν λεγόμενα, τὸ πρόπον ἂν μὴ δυνώμεθα πάντως ἀποδιδόναι, συγγιγνώσκειν χρεών· οὐ γὰρ ὡς ῥάδια τὰ θνητὰ ἀλλ' ὡς χαλεπὰ πρὸς δόξαν ὄντα ἀπεικάζειν δεῖ διανοεῖσθαι. ΚΡΙ. ταῦτα δὴ βουλόμενος ὑμᾶς ὑπομνῆσαι, καὶ τὸ τῆς συγγνώμης οὐκ ἔλαττον ἀλλὰ μείζον αἰτῶν περὶ τῶν μελλόντων ῥηθήσεσθαι, πάντα ταῦτα εἶρηκα, ὦ Σώκρατες. εἰ δὴ δικαίως αἰτεῖν φαίνομαι τὴν δωρεάν, ἐκόντες δίδοτε. ΣΩ. τί δ' οὐ μέλλομεν, ὦ Κριτία, δίδοναι; καὶ πρὸς γε ἔτι τρίτῳ δεδόσθω ταῦτ' οὗτο Ἑρμοκράτει παρ' ἡμῶν. δῆλον γὰρ ὡς ὀλίγον ὕστερον, ὅταν αὐτὸν δέῃ λέγειν,

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S: Why ever would we refuse your request, Critias? And let's grant the same favour again to our third speaker, Hermocrates. For it is obvious that in due course, when it is his turn to speak, he will make the same request as yourself, in which case, without being compelled to repeat the same opening request, let him rest assured that this indulgence is also available to him when it is his turn to speak so that he can provide a different preamble. And yet I forewarn you, dear Critias, of the disposition of your audience. The playwright who went before you was amazingly well received by them, and you will therefore require a great deal of indulgence if you are going to be a competent successor.

παραιτήσεται καθάπερ ὑμεῖς· ἴν' οὖν ἑτέραν ἀρχὴν ἐκπορίζεται καὶ μὴ τὴν αὐτὴν ἀναγκασθῇ λέγειν, ὡς ὑπαρχούσης αὐτῷ συγγνώμης εἰς τότε οὕτω λεγέτω. προλέγω γε μὴν, ὦ φίλε Κριτία, σοὶ τὴν τοῦ θεάτρου διάνοιαν, ὅτι θαυμαστῶς ὁ πρότερος ἠὲδοκίμηκεν ἐν αὐτῷ ποιητής, ὥστε τῆς συγγνώμης δεήσει τινός σοι παμπόλλης, εἰ μέλλεις αὐτὰ δυνατός γενέσθαι παραλαβεῖν. ΕΡ. ταῦτ' οὖν μὴν, ὦ Σώκρατες, κάμοι παραγγέλλεις ὅπερ

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HE: The same warning you gave to this man also applies to me, Socrates. But, of course, a faint-hearted man never set up a trophy, Critias, so you must embark upon your discourse courageously, calling upon Paeon and the Muses to present and sing the praises of your fellow citizens of old, who were such good people.

τῷδε. ἀλλὰ γὰρ ἀθυμοῦντες ἄνδρες οὕτω τρόπαιον ἔστησαν, ὧ Κριτία· προΐεναι τε οὖν ἐπὶ τὸν λόγον ἀνδρείως χρή, καὶ τὸν Παίωνα τε καὶ τὰς μούσας ἐπικαλούμενον τοὺς παλαιούς πολίτας ἀγαθοὺς ὄντας ἀναφαίνειν τε καὶ ὑμνεῖν. ΚΡΙ. ὦ φίλε Ἑρμόκρατες, τῆς ὑστέρας τεταγμένος, ἐπίπροσθεν ἔχων ἄλλον, ἔτι θαρρεῖς. τοῦτο μὲν οὖν οἷόν ἐστιν, αὐτό σοι τάχα δηλώσει παραμυθουμένω δ' οὖν καὶ

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C1: My dear Hermocrates, having been assigned last place, with someone else going before you, you are still courageous, but you will soon find out what this process is really like. However, emboldened by your encouraging words, I must have faith and call upon the other gods besides those you mentioned, and especially upon Memory. For the most important of all our accounts rests more or less with this god. Indeed, if I can adequately recall and proclaim what was once spoken by the priests and preserved here by Solon, I am quite confident that I shall be deemed by this audience to have done justice to my assigned task. So that is what I must now undertake without any further delay.

παραθαρρύνοντί σοι πειστέον, καὶ πρὸς οἷς θεοῖς εἶπες τούς τε ἄλλους κλητέον καὶ δὴ καὶ τὰ μάλιστα Μνημοσύνην. σχεδὸν γὰρ τὰ μέγιστα ἡμῖν τῶν λόγων ἐν ταύτῃ τῇ θεῷ πάντ' ἐστίν· μνησθέντες γὰρ ἱκανῶς καὶ ἀπαγγείλαντες τὰ ποτε ῥηθέντα ὑπὸ τῶν ἱερέων καὶ δεῦρο ὑπὸ Σόλωνος κομισθέντα σχεδὸν οἶδ' ὅτι τῷδε τῷ θεάτρῳ δόξομεν τὰ προσήκοντα μετρίως ἀποτετελεκέναι. τοῦτ' οὖν αὐτ' ἤδη δραστέον, καὶ μελλήτεον οὐδὲν ἔτι.

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C1: First of all, then, let us recall that it is in total nine thousand years since war was declared between those dwelling outside the Pillars² of Heracles and all those who dwell within them. This I must now recount. One side was led, and the entire war was said to have been waged by this city of ours, while the other side was led by the kings of the island of Atlantis, which was, according to reports, an island, once larger than Libya and Asia combined. But nowadays, having been

submerged during an earthquake, it acts as a barrier of mud obstructing those who wish to sail out into the open ocean from there.

πάντων δὴ πρῶτον μνησθῶμεν ὅτι τὸ κεφάλαιον ἦν ἐνακισχίλια ἔτη, ἀφ' οὗ γεγωνὺς ἐμηνύθη πόλεμος τοῖς θ' ὑπὲρ Ἡρακλείας στήλας ἔξω κατοικοῦσιν καὶ τοῖς ἐντὸς πᾶσιν· ὃν δεῖ νῦν διαπεραίνειν. τῶν μὲν οὖν ἦδε ἡ πόλις ἄρξασα καὶ πάντα τὸν πόλεμον διαπολεμήσασα ἐλέγετο, τῶν δ' οἱ τῆς Ἀτλαντίδος νήσου βασιλῆς, ἦν δὴ Λιβύης καὶ Ἀσίας μείζω νῆσον οὖσαν ἔφαμεν εἶναι ποτε, νῦν δὲ ὑπὸ σεισμῶν δῦσαν ἄπορον πηλὸν τοῖς ἐνθένδε ἐκπλέουσιν

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CI: As for the various non-Greek peoples, and whatever Greek races there were at the time, the course of our narrative, as it unfolds, will reveal in each case the details of what happened to them everywhere. But in the case of the Athenians and the adversaries against whom they fought, it is necessary to begin by first recounting the power of each side and their political systems. And in speaking of these we must give precedence to our own people. Once upon a time, the gods, without any strife, allotted the entire earth. For it would not be right to suggest that gods are ignorant of what is proper to each of them, nor indeed that, having recognised what most belongs to other gods, they attempt to acquire this for themselves through strife. So, by lots, each was justly allotted his own, and they settled regions. And having settled them, they reared us, their possessions and livestock, except that they did not use physical force as shepherds do when driving their flocks to pasture with a staff. Instead, they led and steered the entire mortal creature in the way that is easiest to manage any living creature, guiding it from the stern, after their own mind, by the rudder of persuasion.

ἐπὶ τὸ πᾶν πέλαγος, ὥστε μηκέτι πορεύεσθαι, κωλυτὴν παρασχεῖν. ΚΡΙ. τὰ μὲν δὴ πολλὰ ἔθνη βάρβαρα, καὶ ὅσα Ἑλλήνων ἦν γέννη τότε, καθ' ἕκαστα ἢ τοῦ λόγου διέξοδος οἷον ἀνειλλομένη τὸ προστυχὸν ἑκάσταχοῦ δηλώσει· τὸ δὲ Ἀθηναίων τε τῶν τότε καὶ τῶν ἐναντίων, οἷς

διεπολέμησαν, ἀνάγκη κατ' ἀρχὰς διελθεῖν πρῶτα, τήν τε δύναμιν ἐκατέρων καὶ τὰς πολιτείας. αὐτῶν δὲ τούτων τὰ τῇδε ἔμπροσθεν προτιμητέον εἰπεῖν. θεοὶ γὰρ ἅπασαν γῆν ποτε κατὰ τοὺς τόπους διελάγχανον—οὐ κατ' ἔριν· οὐ γὰρ ἂν ὀρθὸν ἔχοι λόγον θεοὺς ἀγνοεῖν τὰ πρέποντα ἐκάστοις αὐτῶν, οὐδ' αὖ γινώσκοντας τὸ μᾶλλον ἄλλοις προσῆκον τοῦτο ἐτέρους αὐτοῖς δι' ἐρίδων ἐπιχειρεῖν κτᾶσθαι—δίκης δὴ κλήροις τὸ φίλον λαγχάνοντες κατώκιζον τὰς χώρας, καὶ κατοικίσαντες, οἷον νομῆς ποιμνία, κτήματα καὶ θρέμματα ἑαυτῶν ἡμᾶς ἔτρεφον, πλὴν οὐ σώμασι

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CI: Now, other gods, having been allotted other regions, ruled over them, but Hephaestus and Athena, sharing a common nature as siblings born from the same father, sharing also the same pursuit of philosophy and craftsmanship, were allotted a single region. This was our region, a fitting and natural home for excellence and wisdom, and they produced good men, born from its soil, and they implanted in their minds the order of its political system. Although the names of these people have been preserved, their works have disappeared owing to the destructions of their successors and the long time period involved. For the people left behind on each occasion, as we said before, were illiterate mountain folk who had only heard the names of that region's rulers but knew little of their deeds. So, although they were happy to give these names to their own offspring, they were unaware of the excellent qualities and the laws of their predecessors, save for some obscure reports. They and their children lacked the necessities of life for many generations, and so they were preoccupied with what they lacked, and this became their topic of conversation and they had no interest in events of the distant past. For mythology and interest in antiquity come to cities along with leisure when they see that some people have already been furnished with the necessities of life, but not before then.

σώματα βιαζόμενοι, καθάπερ ποιμένες κτήνη πληγῇ νέμοντες, ἀλλ' ἢ μάλιστα εὖστροφον ζῶον, ἐκ πρύμνης ἀπευθύνοντες, οἷον οἶακι πειθοῖ

ψυχῆς ἐφαπτόμενοι κατὰ τὴν αὐτῶν διάνοιαν, οὕτως ἄγοντες τὸ θνητὸν πᾶν ἐκυβέρνην. ἄλλοι μὲν οὖν κατ' ἄλλους τόπους κληρουχήσαντες θεῶν ἐκεῖνα ἐκόσμου, Ἥφαιστος δὲ κοινήν καὶ Ἀθηναίαν φύσιν ἔχοντες, ἅμα μὲν ἀδελφὴν ἐκ ταύτου τοῦ πατρός, ἅμα δὲ φιλοσοφίᾳ φιλοτεχνίᾳ τε ἐπὶ τὰ αὐτὰ ἐλθόντες, οὕτω μίαν ἄμφω λῆξιν τήνδε τὴν χώραν εἰλήχοντες ὥς οἰκίαν καὶ πρόσφορον ἀρετῇ καὶ φρονήσει πεφυκυῖαν, ἄνδρας δὲ ἀγαθοὺς ἐμποιήσαντες αὐτόχθονας ἐπὶ νοῦν ἔθεσαν τὴν τῆς πολιτείας τάξιν· ὧν τὰ μὲν ὀνόματα σέσωται, τὰ δὲ ἔργα διὰ τὰς τῶν παραλαμβάνοντων φθορὰς καὶ τὰ μήκη τῶν χρόνων ἠφανίσθη. τὸ γὰρ περιλειπούμενον αἰεὶ γένος, ὥσπερ καὶ πρόσθεν ἐρρήθη, κατελείπετο ὄρειον καὶ ἀγράμματον, τῶν ἐν τῇ χώρᾳ δυναστῶν τὰ ὀνόματα ἀκηκοὺς μόνον καὶ βραχέα πρὸς αὐτοῖς τῶν ἔργων. τὰ μὲν οὖν ὀνόματα τοῖς ἐκγόνοις ἐτίθεντο ἀγαπῶντες, τὰς δὲ ἀρετὰς καὶ τοὺς νόμους τῶν ἔμπροσθεν οὐκ εἰδότες, εἰ μὴ σκοτεινὰς περὶ ἐκάστων τινὰς ἀκοάς, ἐν ἀπορίᾳ δὲ τῶν ἀναγκαίων ἐπὶ πολλὰς γενεὰς ὄντες αὐτοὶ

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C1: That's why the names of the ancients have been preserved, but not their deeds. My evidence for what I say is the report of Solon that the Egyptian priests, describing the war that once took place, used many of these very names such as Cecrops, Erechtheus, Erichthoneus, Erysichthon, and most of the various names of the predecessors of Theseus that are recorded. The same applies to the names of the women too. And, indeed, the figure of the goddess as depicted, displayed as she is in full battle armour, accords with the custom of the time whereby military activities were once common to men and women alike, an indication that in all cases where male and female creatures congregate together, it is always naturally possible for each kind to pursue its own proper excellence in common.

καὶ παῖδες, πρὸς οἷς ἠπόρουν τὸν νοῦν ἔχοντες, τούτων πέρι καὶ τοὺς λόγους ποιούμενοι, τῶν ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν καὶ πάλαι ποτὲ γεγονότων ἡμέλουν. ΚΡΙ. μυθολογία γὰρ ἀναζητήσις τε τῶν παλαιῶν μετὰ σχολῆς ἅμ' ἐπὶ τὰς πόλεις ἔρχεσθον, ὅταν ἴδητόν τις ἤδη τοῦ βίου τὰναγκαῖα

κατεσκευασμένα, πρὶν δὲ οὐ. ταύτη δὴ τὰ τῶν παλαιῶν ὀνόματα ἄνευ τῶν ἔργων διασέσονται. λέγω δὲ αὐτὰ τεκμαιρόμενος ὅτι Κέκροπός τε καὶ Ἑρεχθέως καὶ Ἑριχθονίου καὶ Ἑρυσίχθονος τῶν τε ἄλλων τὰ πλεῖστα ὅσαπερ καὶ Θησέως τῶν ἄνω περὶ τῶν ὀνομάτων ἐκάστων ἀπομνημονεύεται, τούτων ἐκείνους τὰ πολλὰ ἐπονομάζοντας τοὺς ἱερέας Σόλων ἔφη τὸν τότε διηγεῖσθαι πόλεμον, καὶ τὰ τῶν γυναικῶν κατὰ τὰ αὐτά. καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ τῆς θεοῦ σχῆμα καὶ ἄγαλμα, ὡς κοινὰ τότε ἦν τὰ ἐπιτηδεύματα ταῖς τε γυναιξὶ καὶ τοῖς ἀνδράσι τὰ περὶ τὸν πόλεμον, οὕτω κατ' ἐκείνον τὸν νόμον ὠπλισμένην τὴν θεὸν ἀνάθημα εἶναι τοῖς τότε, ἔνδειγμα ὅτι πάνθ'

110c

C1: Now, in those days, in this region, the various classes among our citizens were engaged in manufacturing and producing food from the earth. But the military class, having been set apart by divine men at the outset, dwelt separately, possessed of everything that was appropriate for their sustenance and training. None of them had any private property, and they asked their fellow citizens for no sustenance beyond the limits of sufficiency. Indeed, their entire lifestyle and customs were the same as those we described yesterday when speaking of those guardians whom we hypothesised. Furthermore, what is said about our land is persuasive and true: firstly that its boundaries at the time were defined by the Isthmus, and on the land side by the heights of Cithaeron and Parnes, and the boundaries went down with Oropus on the right, and Asopus constituted the sea boundary on the left. The soil in the region was more excellent than anywhere else, and that is why it was able to support a large army which was exempt from working the land. And there is strong evidence for its past excellence, since what's left nowadays is a match for any territory in productivity and fruitfulness and in the abundant pasture it affords to any livestock. But its produce in those days, as well as being excellent, came forth in vast quantities.

ὅσα σύννομα ζῶα θήλεα καὶ ὅσα ἄρρενα, τὴν προσήκουσαν ἀρετὴν ἐκάστῳ γένει πᾶν κοινῇ δυνατόν ἐπιτηδεύειν πέφυκεν. ὥικει δὲ δὴ τότε

ἐν τῇδε τῇ χώρᾳ τὰ μὲν ἄλλα ἔθνη τῶν πολιτῶν περὶ τὰς δημιουργίας ὄντα καὶ τὴν ἐκ τῆς γῆς τροφήν, τὸ δὲ μάχιμον ὑπ' ἀνδρῶν θείων κατ' ἀρχὰς ἀφορισθὲν ὥκει χωρίς, πάντα εἰς τροφήν καὶ παίδευσιν τὰ προσήκοντα ἔχον, ἴδιον μὲν αὐτῶν οὐδεὶς οὐδὲν κεκτημένος, ἅπαντα δὲ πάντων κοινὰ νομίζοντες αὐτῶν, πέρα δὲ ἱκανῆς τροφῆς οὐδὲν ἀξιοῦντες παρὰ τῶν ἄλλων δέχεσθαι πολιτῶν, καὶ πάντα δὴ τὰ χθὲς λεχθέντα ἐπιτηδεύματα ἐπιτηδεύοντες, ὅσα περὶ τῶν ὑποτεθέντων ἐρρήθη φυλάκων. καὶ δὴ καὶ τὸ περὶ τῆς χώρας ἡμῶν πιθανὸν καὶ ἀληθὲς ἐλέγετο, πρῶτον μὲν τοὺς ὅρους αὐτὴν ἐν τῷ τότε ἔχειν ἀφωρισμένους πρὸς τὸν Ἰσθμὸν καὶ τὸ κατὰ τὴν ἄλλην ἡπειρον μέχρι τοῦ Κιθαιρώνος καὶ Πάρνηθος τῶν ἄκρων, καταβαίνειν δὲ τοὺς ὅρους ἐν δεξιᾷ τὴν Ὠρωπίαν ἔχοντας, ἐν ἀριστερᾷ δὲ πρὸς θαλάττης ἀφορίζοντας τὸν Ἀσωπὸν· ἀρετῇ δὲ πᾶσαν γῆν ὑπὸ τῆς ἐνθάδε ὑπερβάλλεσθαι, διὸ καὶ δυνατὴν εἶναι τότε τρέφειν τὴν χώραν στρατοπέδον πολὺ τῶν περὶ γῆν ἀργὸν ἔργων. ΚΡΙ. μέγα δὲ τεκμήριον ἀρετῆς· τὸ γὰρ νῦν αὐτῆς λείψανον ἐνάμιλλόν ἐστι πρὸς ἡντινοῦν τῷ πάμφορον εὐκαρπὸν τε εἶναι καὶ τοῖς ζώοις πᾶσιν εὐβοτον. τότε δὲ πρὸς τῷ κάλλει καὶ παμπλήθει ταῦτα ἔφερεν. πῶς οὖν δὴ τοῦτο πιστόν, καὶ κατὰ τί λείψανον τῆς τότε γῆς ὁρθῶς ἂν λέγοιτο; πᾶσα ἀπὸ τῆς ἄλλης ἡπείρου μακρὰ προτείνουσα εἰς τὸ πέλαγος οἷον ἄκρα κεῖται· τὸ δὴ τῆς θαλάττης ἀγγεῖον περὶ αὐτὴν τυγχάνει πᾶν ἀγχιβαθὲς ὄν. πολλῶν οὖν γεγονότων καὶ μεγάλων κατακλυσμῶν ἐν τοῖς ἐνακισχιλίοις ἔτεσι—τοσαῦτα γὰρ πρὸς τὸν νῦν ἀπ' ἐκείνου τοῦ χρόνου

111b

C1: Why should we believe this story and what is left of the land of old to confirm this account? The land as a whole is a long promontory, so to speak, extending from the general land mass far out into the ocean, and the seabed round about is of great depth. Now, although there have been many enormous floods during the nine thousand years that have elapsed since that era, the earth that washed down from the heights during the ongoing deluges did not accumulate significantly, as happens in other places, because it constantly flowed down and vanished into the deep. What is left then, comparing that era with the

present, resembles the skeleton of a diseased body. It is just like what happens on small islands where any fat, rich soil has flowed away, leaving behind only the bare frame of the territory. But during that era the land was pristine, our present mountains were lofty hills, and the stony plains of what we call Phelleus were covered in rich soil. The mountains contained lots of trees of which there is still evidence nowadays, for although some of our mountains now support only bees, it was not long ago that roof timbers were cut from the trees there for use in huge buildings, and the rafters still survive to this day. And there were also many cultivated trees providing fodder aplenty for livestock. What's more, the soil was made fruitful by the annual rains sent by Zeus, which were not wasted as happens nowadays by flowing into the sea from land that has been made bare. Rather, since the land had plenty of soil, it could indeed receive the water and store it in impervious clay ground. The water stored there was sent forth from the heights through hollows, providing plenty of flowing water for springs and rivers. The shrines that still remain where the springs once stood are an indication that what we are now saying about this region is true.

γέγονεν ἔτη—τὸ τῆς γῆς ἐν τούτοις τοῖς χρόνοις καὶ πάθουσιν ἐκ τῶν ὑψηλῶν ἀπορρέον οὔτε χῶμα, ὡς ἐν ἄλλοις τόποις, προχοῖ λόγου ἄξιον αἰεὶ τε κύκλῳ περιρρέον εἰς βάθος ἀφανίζεται· λέλειπται δὲ, καθάπερ ἐν ταῖς σμικραῖς νήσοις, πρὸς τὰ τότε τὰ νῦν οἷον νοσήσαντος σώματος ὅστ᾽, περιερρυηκυίας τῆς γῆς ὅση πείρα καὶ μαλακή, τοῦ λεπτοῦ σώματος τῆς χώρας μόνου λειφθέντος. τότε δὲ ἀκέραιος οὔσα τά τε ὄρη γηλόφους ὑψηλοὺς εἶχε, καὶ τὰ φελλέως νῦν ὀνομασθέντα πεδία πλήρη γῆς πείρας ἐκέκτητο, καὶ πολλὴν ἐν τοῖς ὄρεσιν ὕλην εἶχεν, ἥς καὶ νῦν ἔτι φανερά· τεκμήρια· τῶν γὰρ ὀρῶν ἔστιν ἃ νῦν μὲν ἔχει μελίτταις μόναις τροφήν, χρόνος δ' οὐ πάμπολυς ὅτε δένδρων αὐτόθεν εἰς οἰκοδομήσεις τὰς μεγίστας ἐρεψίμων τμηθέντων στεγάσματ' ἔστιν ἔτι σα. πολλὰ δ' ἦν ἄλλ' ἡμερα ὑψηλὰ δένδρα, νομὴν δὲ βοσκήμασιν ἀμήχανον ἔφερεν. καὶ δὴ καὶ

C1: Such was the natural condition of our region in general, and it was managed of course by true workers of the land, dedicated to this task alone, lovers of all things noble, with natural talents. They had access to the very best land with plenty of water, governed by seasons that were blended to perfection. The arrangement of the city at the time was as follows. Firstly, the Acropolis at that time was not as it is nowadays, washed bare of its soil following a single night of extreme deluge when an earthquake occurred along with the third enormous flood prior to the destruction of the age of Deucalion⁴. But before this, in another era, it was vast, extending from the Eridanos to the Ilisos river, encompassing the Pnyx, with the hill of Lycabettos as a boundary opposite the Pnyx. The entire was covered in earth, and it was more or less flat on top. Outside, under the actual slopes, it was settled by craftsmen and those farmers who worked the land nearby. On the top, the military class dwelt just by themselves around the temple of Athena and Hephaestus, surrounded by a single wall, like the garden of a single household. On the north side, they lived in communal dwellings and provided shared dining halls for the winter, with everything appropriate to their communal political system being available to them in terms of buildings and temples, but without any silver or gold, for none of them had any use for these. Pursuing a middle ground between extravagance and meanness, they built moderate dwellings in which they and their children's children grew old, bequeathing them always to others like themselves. In summer they naturally vacated their enclosed gardens, and their gymnasia and dining halls, and used the southern parts for these purposes. There was a single spring, on the site of the present Acropolis, which has been blocked by the earthquakes, so that nowadays only trickles of water remain in the vicinity, whereas it once provided a plentiful flow of water for everyone at just the right temperature throughout winter and summer.

τὸ κατ' ἐνιαυτὸν ὕδωρ ἑκαρποῦτ' ἐκ Διός, οὐχ ὡς νῦν ἀπολλῦσα ῥέον ἀπὸ ψιλῆς τῆς γῆς εἰς θάλατταν, ἀλλὰ πολλὴν ἔχουσα καὶ εἰς αὐτὴν

καταδεχομένη, τῇ κεραμίδι στεγούση γῇ διαταμιευομένη, τὸ καταποθὲν ἐκ τῶν ὑψηλῶν ὕδωρ εἰς τὰ κοῖλα ἀφιεῖσα κατὰ πάντας τοὺς τόπους παρείχετο ἄφθονα κρηνῶν καὶ ποταμῶν νάματα, ὧν καὶ νῦν ἔτι ἐπὶ ταῖς πηγαῖς πρότερον οὖσαι ἱερὰ λελειμμένα ἐστὶν σημεῖα ὅτι περὶ αὐτῆς ἀληθῆ λέγεται τὰ νῦν. τὰ μὲν οὖν τῆς ἄλλης χώρας φύσει τε οὕτως εἶχε, καὶ διεκεκόσμητο ὡς εἰκὸς ὑπὸ γεωργῶν μὲν ἀληθινῶν καὶ πραττόντων αὐτὸ τοῦτο, φιλοκάλων δὲ καὶ εὐφυῶν, γῆν δὲ ἀρίστην καὶ ὕδωρ ἀφθονώτατον ἐχόντων καὶ ὑπὲρ τῆς γῆς ὥρας μετριώτατα κεκραμένας· τὸ δ' ἄστὺ κατωκισμένον ὧδ' ἦν ἐν τῷ τότε χρόνῳ. ΚΡΙ. πρῶτον μὲν τὸ τῆς ἀκροπόλεως εἶχε τότε οὐχ ὡς τὰ νῦν ἔχει. νῦν μὲν γὰρ μία γενομένη νῦξ ὑγρά διαφερόντως γῆς αὐτὴν ψιλὴν περιτήξασα πεποίηκε, σεισμῶν ἅμα καὶ πρὸ τῆς ἐπὶ Δευκαλίωνος φθορᾶς τρίτου πρότερον ὕδατος ἐξαισίου γενομένου· τὸ δὲ πρὶν ἐν ἑτέρῳ χρόνῳ μέγεθος μὲν ἦν πρὸς τὸν Ἡριδανὸν καὶ τὸν Ἰλισὸν ἀποβεβηκυῖα καὶ περιεληφυῖα ἐντὸς τὴν Πύκνα καὶ τὸν Λυκαβηττὸν ὄρον ἐκ τοῦ καταντικρὺ τῆς Πυκνὸς ἔχουσα, γεώδης δ' ἦν πᾶσα καὶ πλήν ὀλίγον ἐπίπεδος ἄνωθεν. ὥκειτο δὲ τὰ μὲν ἔξωθεν, ὑπ' αὐτὰ τὰ πλάγια αὐτῆς, ὑπὸ τῶν δημιουργῶν καὶ τῶν γεωργῶν ὅσοι πλησίον ἐγεώργουν· τὰ δ' ἐπάνω τὸ μάχιμον αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ μόνον γένος περὶ τὸ τῆς Ἀθηνᾶς Ἡφαίστου τε ἱερὸν κατωκίηκεν, οἷον μιᾶς οἰκίας κῆπον ἐνὶ περιβόλῳ προσπεριβεβλημένοι. τὰ γὰρ πρόσβορρα αὐτῆς ὥκουν οἰκίας κοινὰς καὶ συσσίτια χειμερινὰ κατασκευασάμενοι, καὶ πάντα ὅσα πρέποντ' ἦν τῇ κοινῇ πολιτείᾳ δι' οἰκοδομήσεων ὑπάρχειν αὐτῶν καὶ τῶν ἱερῶν, ἄνευ χρυσοῦ καὶ ἀργύρου—τούτοις γὰρ οὐδὲν οὐδαμῶσε προσεχρῶντο, ἀλλὰ τὸ μέσον ὑπερηφανίας καὶ ἀνελευθερίας μεταδιώκοντες κοσμίας ὥκοδομοῦντο οἰκήσεις, ἐν αἷς αὐτοὶ τε καὶ ἐκγόνων ἐκγονοὶ καταγερῶντες ἄλλοις ὁμοίοις τὰς αὐτὰς ἀεὶ παρεδίδουσαν—τὰ δὲ πρὸς νότου, κήπους καὶ γυμνάσια συσσίτια τε ἀνέντες οἷα θέρους, κατεχρῶντο ἐπὶ ταῦτα αὐτοῖς. κρήνη δ' ἦν μία κατὰ τὸν τῆς νῦν ἀκροπόλεως τόπον, ἧς

112d

C1: This is how their lives were arranged as guardians of their own citizens and leaders of the other Greek peoples, their willing subjects.

They kept careful watch that the number of men and women capable of military service at any stage was always more or less the same at about twenty thousand. Now these Athenians, being themselves people of this sort, were renowned above all peoples of that age, justly managing their own region and Greece generally in such a consistent manner, famous throughout all of Europe and Asia for their physical beauty and the overall excellence of their souls. As for their adversaries, the sort of people they were and their origins, if my memory of what we heard as children does not desert me, I shall now bring their stories centre stage to share with you, my friends.

ἀποσβεσθείσης ὑπὸ τῶν σεισμῶν τὰ νῦν νάματα μικρὰ κύκλῳ καταλέλειπται, τοῖς δὲ τότε πᾶσιν παρείχεν ἄφθονον ῥεῦμα, εὐκράς οὔσα πρὸς χειμῶνά τε καὶ θέρος. τούτῳ δὴ κατώκουν τῷ σχήματι, τῶν μὲν αὐτῶν πολιτῶν φύλακες, τῶν δὲ ἄλλων Ἑλλήνων ἡγεμόνες ἐκόντων, πλῆθος δὲ διαφυλάττοντες ὅτι μάλιστα ταῦτ' οὖν αὐτῶν εἶναι πρὸς τὸν αἰὲ χρόνον ἀνδρῶν καὶ γυναικῶν, τὸ δυνατὸν πολεμεῖν ἤδη καὶ τὸ ἔτι, περὶ δύο μάλιστα ὄντας μυριάδας. οὗτοι μὲν οὖν δὴ τοιοῦτοί τε ὄντες αὐτοὶ καὶ τινα τοιοῦτον αἰὲ τρόπον τήν τε αὐτῶν καὶ τήν Ἑλλάδα δίκη διοικοῦντες, ἐπὶ πᾶσαν Εὐρώπην καὶ Ἀσίαν κατὰ τε σωμάτων κάλλη καὶ κατὰ τήν τῶν ψυχῶν παντοίαν ἀρετὴν ἐλλόγιμοί τε ἦσαν καὶ ὀνομαστότατοι πάντων τῶν τότε· τὰ δὲ δὴ τῶν ἀντιπολεμησάντων αὐτοῖς οἷα ἦν ὥς τε ἀπ' ἀρχῆς ἐγένετο, μνήμης ἂν μὴ στερηθῶμεν ὧν ἔτι παῖδες ὄντες ἠκούσαμεν, εἰς τὸ μέσον αὐτὰ νῦν ἀποδώσομεν ὑμῖν τοῖς φίλοις εἶναι κοινά.

113a

C1: But before I begin my account, I owe you a brief explanation in case you are surprised to hear of so many non-Greeks with Greek names. You shall now discover the reason for this. Solon, intending to make use of the Egyptian account in his own poem, found out, on investigating the significance of the names, that those Egyptians who had written them down initially had translated them into their own language. So he himself, having recovered the sense of each name, put them back once more into our language and wrote them down. And

these writings were in the possession of my grandfather and are in my own possession now. Indeed, I studied them carefully as a child. So do not be surprised if you hear names of this sort, belonging to our region; you have the explanation.

KPI. τὸ δ' ἔτι βραχὺ πρὸ τοῦ λόγου δεῖ δηλῶσαι, μὴ πολλάκις ἀκούοντες Ἑλληνικὰ βαρβάρων ἀνδρῶν ὀνόματα θαυμάζητε· τὸ γὰρ αἴτιον αὐτῶν πεύσεσθε. Σόλων, ἅτ' ἐπινοῶν εἰς τὴν αὐτοῦ ποίησιν καταχρήσασθαι τῷ λόγῳ, διαπυνθανόμενος τὴν τῶν ὀνομάτων δύναμιν, ἤρρεν τοὺς τε Αἰγυπτίους τοὺς πρῶτους ἐκείνους αὐτὰ γραψαμένους εἰς τὴν αὐτῶν φωνὴν μετενηνοχότας, αὐτός τε αὖ πάλιν ἐκάστου τὴν διάνοιαν ὀνόματος ἀναλαμβάνων εἰς τὴν ἡμετέραν ἄγων φωνὴν ἀπεγράφετο· καὶ ταῦτα γε δὴ τὰ γράμματα παρὰ τῷ πάππῳ τ' ἦν καὶ ἔτ' ἐστὶν παρ' ἐμοὶ νῦν, διαμεμελέτηται τε ὑπ' ἐμοῦ παιδὸς ὄντος. ἂν οὖν ἀκούητε τοιαῦτα οἷα καὶ τῆδε ὀνόματα, μὴδὲν ὑμῖν ἔστω θαῦμα· τὸ γὰρ αἴτιον αὐτῶν ἔχετε. μακροῦ δὲ δὴ λόγου τοιάδε τις ἦν ἀρχὴ τότε. καθάπερ ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ἐλέχθη περὶ τῆς τῶν θεῶν λήξεως, ὅτι κατενείμαντο γῆν πᾶσαν ἔνθα μὲν μείζους

113c

CI: Well then, the story, a long one, began somewhat as follows. As was said previously about the allotments of the gods, they portioned the land into lots, some larger some smaller, and instituted sacred places and sacrifices for themselves. And so, Poseidon, being allotted the island of Atlantis⁵, settled his own offspring, begotten of a mortal woman there, in a region of the island described as follows. By the sea, towards the centre of the entire region, there was a plain said to be of sublime excellence, and fertile too. Near the plain, towards the centre, at a distance of some fifty stades, there was a mountain that was low throughout. There was an inhabitant of that mountain, one of the men of that place born originally from its soil. His name was Evenor and he lived with his wife, Leucippe, and they had an only daughter, Cleito. When the girl had reached marriageable age, the father and mother both died. Poseidon was smitten with desire for the girl and made her his consort. He secured the hill on which she dwelt, fortifying it by

making alternating circles of earth and sea, some smaller, some larger, enclosing each other, two of earth, three of seawater, like round wheels in the middle of the island, equidistant from one another on all sides so that they were impassable for people because there were, as yet, no ships and no seafaring. He brought order to the middle part of the island, an easy task for a god, providing two sources of spring water from beneath the ground, one warm, the other overflowing with cool water, and he sent forth from the earth abundant and plentiful food.

λήξεις, ἔνθα δὲ καὶ ἐλάττους, ἱερὰ θυσίας τε αὐτοῖς κατασκευάζοντες, οὕτω δὴ καὶ τὴν νῆσον Ποσειδῶν τὴν Ἀτλαντίδα λαχὼν ἐκγόνους αὐτοῦ κατώκισεν ἐκ θνητῆς γυναικὸς γεννήσας ἔν τινι τόπῳ τοιῷδε τῆς νήσου. πρὸς θαλάττης μὲν, κατὰ δὲ μέσον πάσης πεδίον ἦν, ὃ δὴ πάντων πεδίων κάλλιστον ἀρετῇ τε ἱκανὸν γενέσθαι λέγεται, πρὸς τῷ πεδίῳ δὲ αὖ κατὰ μέσον σταδίου ὡς πεντήκοντα ἀφεςτὸς ἦν ὄρος βραχὺ πάντῃ. τούτῳ δ' ἦν ἔνοικος τῶν ἐκεῖ κατὰ ἀρχὰς ἐκ γῆς ἀνδρῶν γεγονότων Εὐήνωρ μὲν ὄνομα, γυναικὶ δὲ συνοικῶν Λευκίππῃ Κλειτῷ δὲ μονογενῇ θυγατέρα ἐγεννησάσθην. ἤδη δ' εἰς ἀνδρὸς ὥραν ἡκούσης τῆς κόρης ἢ τε μήτηρ τελευτᾷ καὶ ὁ πατήρ, αὐτῆς δὲ εἰς ἐπιθυμίαν Ποσειδῶν ἐλθὼν συμμείγνυται, καὶ τὸν γήλοφον, ἐν ᾧ κατώκιστο, ποιῶν εὐερκῇ περιρρήγνυσιν κύκλῳ, θαλάττης γῆς τε ἐναλλάξ ἐλάττους μεῖζους τε περὶ ἀλλήλους ποιῶν τροχοῦς, δύο μὲν γῆς, θαλάττης δὲ τρεῖς οἷον τορνεύων ἐκ μέσης τῆς νήσου, πάντῃ ἴσον ἀφεςτῶτας, ὥστε ἄβατον ἀνθρώποις εἶναι· πλοῖα γὰρ καὶ τὸ πλεῖν οὐπω τότε ἦν. αὐτὸς δὲ τὴν τε ἐν μέσῳ νῆσον οἷα δὴ θεὸς εὐμαρῶς διεκόσμησεν, ὕδατα μὲν διττὰ ὑπὸ γῆς ἄνω πηγαῖα κομίσας, τὸ μὲν θερμόν, ψυχρὸν δὲ ἐκ κρήνης ἀπορρέον ἕτερον, τροφὴν δὲ παντοίαν καὶ ἱκανὴν ἐκ τῆς γῆς ἀναδιδούς. ΚΡΙ. παίδων δὲ ἀρρένων πέντε γενέσεις διδύμους γεννησάμενος ἐθρέψατο, καὶ τὴν νῆσον τὴν Ἀτλαντίδα πᾶσαν δέκα μέρη καταλείμας τῶν μὲν πρεσβυτάτων τῷ προτέρῳ

114a

C1: Having begotten and reared five pairs of twin male children, he divided the entire island of Atlantis into ten parts, and assigned the

mother's homestead to the eldest of the firstborn twins, including the surrounding portion of land which was the biggest and the best. He installed this son as king over his brothers and appointed the others as rulers giving them dominion over large numbers of people and an extensive territory. He gave names to them all, naming the eldest, the king, after the whole island and the ocean too, which is called the Atlantic because the first-ever person to exercise kingship there was named Atlas. His other twin was granted the extremity of the island towards the Pillars of Heracles, as far as the region now called Gadeira. The place was named after the son whose Greek name was Eumelos, although locally it was Gadeirus in his own region which is named after him. The second pair of twins were called Ampheres and Euaimon. The eldest of the third pair was called Mneseus, while the other twin was called Autochton. The eldest of the fourth pair was called Elasippus, while the other was called Mestor. The eldest of the fifth pair was called Azaes, while the youngest was called Diaprepes. All these brothers, themselves and their descendants, dwelt there for many generations, ruling over numerous other islands of that ocean, and, indeed, as was said previously, governing all the peoples here within the Pillars of Heracles as far as Egypt and Tuscany.

γενομένῳ τήν τε μητρώαν οἴκησιν καὶ τὴν κύκλῳ λῆξιν, πλείστην καὶ ἀρίστην οὖσαν, ἀπένειμε, βασιλέα τε τῶν ἄλλων κατέστησε, τοὺς δὲ ἄλλους ἄρχοντας, ἐκάστῳ δὲ ἀρχὴν πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων καὶ τόπον πολλῆς χώρας ἔδωκεν. ὀνόματα δὲ πᾶσιν ἔθετο, τῷ μὲν πρεσβυτάτῳ καὶ βασιλεῖ τοῦτο οὗ δὴ καὶ πᾶσα ἡ νῆσος τό τε πέλαγος ἔσχεν ἐπωνυμίαν, Ἀτλαντικὸν λεχθέν, ὅτι τοῦνομ' ἦν τῷ πρώτῳ βασιλεύσαντι τότε Ἀτλας· τῷ δὲ διδύμῳ μετ' ἐκεῖνόν τε γενομένῳ, λῆξιν δὲ ἄκρας τῆς νήσου πρὸς Ἡρακλείων σπηλῶν εἰληχότι ἐπὶ τὸ τῆς Γαδερικῆς νῦν χώρας κατ' ἐκεῖνον τὸν τόπον ὀνομαζομένης, Ἑλληνιστὶ μὲν Εὐμηλον, τὸ δ' ἐπιχώριον Γάδειρον, ὅπερ τ' ἦν ἐπὶ κλην ταύτῃ ὄνομ' ἂν παράσχοι. τοῖν δὲ δευτέροιν γενομένοις τὸν μὲν Ἀμφήρη, τὸν δὲ Εὐαίμονα ἐκάλεσεν· τρίτοις δέ, Μνησεά μὲν τῷ προτέρῳ γενομένῳ, τῷ δὲ μετὰ τοῦτον Αὐτόχθονα τῶν δὲ τετάρτων

Ἐλάσιππον μὲν τὸν πρότερον, Μήστορα δὲ τὸν ὕστερον· ἐπὶ δὲ τοῖς πέμπτοις τῷ μὲν ἔμπροσθεν Ἀζάης ὄνομα ἐτέθη, τῷ δ' ὕστερῳ Διαπρέπης. οὗτοι δὴ πάντες αὐτοί τε καὶ ἔκγονοι τούτων ἐπὶ γενεὰς πολλὰς ὥκουν ἄρχοντες μὲν πολλῶν ἄλλων κατὰ τὸ πέλαγος νήσων, ἔτι δέ, ὥσπερ καὶ πρότερον ἐρρήθη, μέχρι τε Αἰγύπτου καὶ Τυρρηνίας τῶν ἐντὸς δεῦρο ἐπάρχοντες.

114d

C1: From Atlas sprang an extensive and revered people whose king, the eldest son, always passed his title on to the eldest of his offspring, thus preserving the kingship over many generations. They acquired enormous wealth such as no line of kings had amassed before or will easily attain in future. They were provided with all the provisions they needed in the city and in the rest of the country. For although a great deal came to them from outside because of their extensive rulership, the island itself furnished most of the provisions of life. Firstly, it yielded whatever solid or fusible materials are extracted or mined from the ground, including a substance that now exists in name only, but was then more than a mere name. This was orichalc, mined in various locations throughout the island, more valuable at the time than anything else except gold. The island also brought forth an abundance of wood for carpenters to work on, and it was well able to sustain animals too, both tame and wild. And, indeed, there was a plentiful population of elephants, for there was enough pasture available for all sorts of creatures, including those who dwelt in marshes, lakes, rivers, or indeed in mountains or on plains, and enough in like manner for this enormous animal, by nature the most voracious creature of all. As well as all this, the island brought forth and easily sustained whatever fragrant products the earth supports nowadays from roots, herbs, trees or juices that ooze from flowers or fruits. There was also the cultivated fruit, the dry sort that is our sustenance, and those products that we use as our source of food, consisting in general of what we call pulses, and whatever grows on trees, providing us with drink, with solid food and oils, and tree-borne fruit that is difficult to store, acting as a

source of pleasure and delectation which we offer to the fatigued to relieve their satiety. All these were brought forth then in limitless abundance and wondrous beauty by this sacred island beneath the sun. So, being in possession of all these products of the earth, they set about organising and building their temples, royal dwellings, harbours and dockyards, and the rest of their territory, based on the following plan.

Ἄτλαντος δὴ πολὺ μὲν ἄλλο καὶ τίμιον γίγνεται γένος, βασιλεὺς δὲ ὁ πρεσβύτατος αἰεὶ τῷ πρεσβυτάτῳ τῶν ἐκγόνων παραδιδούς ἐπὶ γενεὰς πολλὰς τὴν βασιλείαν διέσφζον, πλοῦτον μὲν κεκτημένοι πλήθει τοσοῦτον, ὅσος οὔτε πω πρόσθεν ἐν δυναστείαις τισὶν βασιλέων γέγονεν οὔτε ποτὲ ὕστερον γενέσθαι ῥάδιος, κατεσκευασμένα δὲ πάντ' ἦν αὐτοῖς ὅσα ἐν πόλει καὶ ὅσα κατὰ τὴν ἄλλην χώραν ἦν ἔργον κατασκευάσασθαι. πολλὰ μὲν γὰρ διὰ τὴν ἀρχὴν αὐτοῖς προσήειν ἔξωθεν, πλεῖστα δὲ ἡ νῆσος αὐτὴ παρείχετο εἰς τὰς τοῦ βίου κατασκευάς, πρῶτον μὲν ὅσα ὑπὸ μεταλλείας ὀρυττόμενα στερεὰ καὶ ὅσα τηκτὰ γέγονε, καὶ τὸ νῦν ὀνομαζόμενον μόνον—τότε δὲ πλέον ὀνόματος ἦν τὸ γένος ἐκ γῆς ὀρυττόμενον ὀρειχάλκου κατὰ τόπους πολλοὺς τῆς νήσου, πλὴν χρυσοῦ τιμιώτατον ἐν τοῖς τότε ὄν—καὶ ὅσα ὕλη πρὸς τὰ τεκτόνων διαπονήματα παρέχεται, πάντα φέρουσα ἄφθονα, τὰ τε αὖ περὶ τὰ ζῶα ἱκανῶς ἡμέρα καὶ ἄγρια τρέφουσα. ΚΡΙ. καὶ δὴ καὶ ἐλεφάντων ἦν ἐν αὐτῇ γένος πλεῖστον· νομὴ γὰρ τοῖς τε ἄλλοις ζώοις, ὅσα καθ' ἔλη καὶ λίμνας καὶ ποταμούς, ὅσα

115a

C1: First, they bridged the rings of seawater that surrounded the ancient mother city, creating a way out of and into their palace. They immediately built the palace, at the very outset, in the original dwelling place of the god and his offspring, passing it on from one generation to the next, each adding to its adornments, each doing their best to continually improve upon the work of their predecessor, until they turned the residence into a marvel to behold for the majesty and beauty it displayed. In fact, they dug a canal running from the sea to the outermost circle, three plethra wide, one hundred feet deep and fifty stades long. In this way they created a passage from the sea into

the outer circle by opening up an entrance big enough for the largest ships to sail into. And what's more, at the bridges they made openings in the circles of earth which were separating the circles of seawater, openings wide enough for a single trireme to sail through, and they covered these from above so that the ships travelled underground. For the banks of the earthen circles were high enough above sea level to allow this.

τ' αὖ κατ' ὄρη καὶ ὅσα ἐν τοῖς πεδίοις νέμεται, σύμπασιν παρῆν ἄδην, καὶ τούτῳ κατὰ ταῦτά τῳ ζῳῳ, μεγίστῳ πεφυκότη καὶ πολυβορωτάτῳ. πρὸς δὲ τούτοις, ὅσα εὐώδη τρέφει που γῆ τὰ νῦν, ῥιζῶν ἢ χλόης ἢ ξύλων ἢ χυλῶν στακτῶν εἴτε ἀνθῶν ἢ καρπῶν, ἔφερέν τε ταῦτα καὶ ἔτρεφεν εὖ· ἔτι δὲ τὸν ἡμέρον καρπὸν, τὸν τε ξηρόν, ὃς ἡμῖν τῆς τροφῆς ἔνεκά ἐστιν, καὶ ὅσοις χάριν τοῦ σίτου προσχρώμεθα—καλοῦμεν δὲ αὐτοῦ τὰ μέρη σύμπαντα ὄσπρια—καὶ τὸν ὅσος ξύλινος, πώματα καὶ βρώματα καὶ ἀλείμματα φέρων, παιδιᾶς τε ὃς ἔνεκα ἡδονῆς τε γέγονε δυσθησαύριστος ἀκροδρύων καρπός, ὅσα τε παραμύθια πλησμονῆς μεταδόρπια ἀγαπητὰ κάμνοντι τίθεμεν, ἅπαντα ταῦτα ἢ τότε ποτὲ οὐσα ὑφ' ἡλίῳ νῆσος ἱερὰ καλὰ τε καὶ θαυμαστὰ καὶ πλήθεσιν ἄπειρ' ἔφερεν. ταῦτα οὖν λαμβάνοντες πάντα παρὰ τῆς γῆς κατεσκευάζοντο τὰ τε ἱερὰ καὶ τὰς βασιλικὰς οἰκῆσεις καὶ τοὺς λιμένας καὶ τὰ νεώρια καὶ σύμπασαν τὴν ἄλλην χώραν, τοιαῦδ' ἐν τάξει διακοσμοῦντες. τοὺς τῆς θαλάττης τροχούς, οἳ περὶ τὴν ἀρχαίαν ἦσαν μητρόπολιν, πρῶτον μὲν ἐγεφύρωσαν, ὁδὸν ἔξω καὶ ἐπὶ τὰ βασίλεια ποιοῦμενοι. τὰ δὲ βασίλεια ἐν ταύτῃ τῇ τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ τῶν προγόνων κατοικήσει κατ' ἀρχὰς ἐποίησαντο εὐθύς, ἕτερος δὲ παρ' ἐτέρου δεχόμενος, κεκοσμημένα κοσμῶν,

115d

C1: Now, the largest circle, the one that opened directly to the sea, was three stades wide, while the next circle, the earthen one, was the same width as that one. Of the second pair, the circle of water was two stades wide, while the circle of dry land was again equal in width to the previous circle of water. The circle running round the central island itself was one stade wide, while that island on which the palace stood

had a diameter of five stades. This island and the circles and the bridge which was one plethron wide, they enclosed roundabout on every side with a stone wall, erecting towers and gates upon the bridges on either side at the sea crossings. They quarried the stone, some of which was white, some black, some red, from beneath the central island, all over, and from beneath the inner and outer circles. And by quarrying the stone, they simultaneously hollowed out a pair of internal docks which they covered over with native rock. Some of their buildings were simple, while in others they combined stone of various colours to amuse themselves, thus making them naturally pleasing to the eye. They covered the entire wall surrounding the outer circle with brass all around, as if they were painting it, while they covered the wall of the inner circle with a coat of tin, and the wall surrounding the acropolis itself with orichalc, which gave it a fiery gleam.

ὑπερεβάλλετο εἰς δύναμιν αἰεὶ τὸν ἔμπροσθεν, ἕως εἰς ἔκπληξιν μεγέθεσιν κάλλεσιν τε ἔργων ἰδεῖν τὴν οἴκησιν ἀπηργάσαντο. διώρυχα μὲν γὰρ ἐκ τῆς θαλάττης ἀρχόμενοι τρίπλεθρον τὸ πλάτος, ἑκατὸν δὲ ποδῶν βάθος, μήκος δὲ πεντήκοντα σταδίων, ἐπὶ τὸν ἐξωτάτω τροχὸν συνέτρησαν, καὶ τὸν ἀνάπλουν ἐκ τῆς θαλάττης αὐτῇ πρὸς ἐκείνον ὡς εἰς λιμένα ἐποίησαντο, διελόντες στόμα ναυσὶν ταῖς μεγίσταις ἱκανὸν εἰσπλεῖν. καὶ δὴ καὶ τοὺς τῆς γῆς τροχοὺς, οἳ τοὺς τῆς θαλάττης διεῖργον, κατὰ τὰς γεφύρας διεῖλον ὅσον μιᾷ τριήρει διέκπλουν εἰς ἀλλήλους, καὶ κατεστέγασαν ἄνωθεν ὥστε τὸν ὑπόπλουν κάτωθεν εἶναι· τὰ γὰρ τῶν τῆς γῆς τροχῶν χεῖλη βάθος εἶχεν ἱκανὸν ὑπερέχον τῆς θαλάττης. ἦν δὲ ὁ μὲν μέγιστος τῶν τροχῶν, εἰς ὃν ἡ θάλαττα συνετέτρητο, τριστάδιος τὸ πλάτος, ὁ δ' ἐξῆς τῆς γῆς ἴσος ἐκεῖνῳ· τοῖν δὲ δευτέρῳ ὁ μὲν ὑγρὸς δυοῖν σταδίοις πλάτος, ὁ δὲ ξηρὸς ἴσος αὖ πάλιν τῷ πρόσθεν ὑγρῷ· σταδίου δὲ ὁ περὶ αὐτὴν τὴν ἐν μέσῳ νῆσον περιθέων. ΚΡΙ. ἡ δὲ νῆσος, ἐν ᾗ τὰ βασιλεία ἦν, πέντε σταδίων τὴν διάμετρον εἶχεν. αὐτὴν δὴ κύκλῳ καὶ τοὺς τροχοὺς καὶ τὴν γέφυραν πλεθριαίαν τὸ πλάτος οὔσαν ἔνθεν καὶ ἔνθεν λιθίνῳ περιεβάλλοντο τεῖχει, πύργους καὶ πύλας ἐπὶ τῶν γεφυρῶν κατὰ τὰς τῆς θαλάττης διαβάσεις ἑκασταχόσε ἐπιστήσαντες· τὸν δὲ λίθον ἔτεμνον ὑπὸ τῆς

νήσου κύκλω τῆς ἐν μέσῳ καὶ ὑπὸ τῶν τροχῶν ἔξωθεν καὶ ἐντός, τὸν μὲν λευκόν, τὸν δὲ μέλανα, τὸν δὲ ἐρυθρὸν ὄντα, τέμνοντες δὲ ἅμ' ἡργάζοντο νεωσοίκους κοίλους διπλοῦς ἐντός, κατηρεφεῖς αὐτῇ τῇ πέτρᾳ. καὶ τῶν οἰκοδομημάτων τὰ μὲν ἀπλᾶ, τὰ δὲ μειγνύντες τοὺς λίθους ποικίλα ὕφαινον παιδιᾶς χάριν, ἡδονὴν αὐτοῖς σύμφυτον ἀπονέμοντες· καὶ τοῦ μὲν περὶ τὸν ἔξωτάτῳ τροχὸν τείχους χαλκῷ περιελάμβανον πάντα τὸν περίδρομον, οἷον ἀλοιφῇ προσχρώμενοι, τοῦ δ' ἐντὸς καττιτέρω περιέτηκον, τὸν δὲ

116c

C1: The palace within the acropolis was designed as follows. In the centre, on the very spot, surrounded by a wall of gold, was a sacred shrine on untrodden ground, dedicated to Cleito and Poseidon. This stood in the place where their family of ten kings was initially begotten and born. To this very place, every year, the first fruits from all ten regions were brought as an offering to each of the kings. There was also a temple to Poseidon himself, one stade in length, three plethra wide, with its height duly proportioned to these dimensions, while its appearance was somehow foreign. The entire exterior of the temple was overlaid with silver, except for the acroteria, which were covered with gold. On the inside the ceiling was all ivory, decorated with gold and silver and orichalc, while everything else, including the walls, columns and floor, was covered with orichalc. Within, they erected golden statues depicting the god standing upon a chariot, controlling a team of six winged horses, he himself being so tall that his head touched the roof. Encircling this were statues of a hundred Nereids riding upon dolphins, for people at the time believed that there were this many Nereids. Inside, there were also many other statues erected by private individuals. Outside, around the temple, stood golden images of the wives of the ten kings and their descendants, and various other large statues of the kings and of private persons from the city itself, or from foreign places over which they ruled. Their size and workmanship were in harmony with the overall

design, and the palace was similarly well suited to the sheer scale of their rulership and the glory of the shrine.

περὶ αὐτὴν τὴν ἀκρόπολιν ὀρειχάλκῳ μαρμαρυγὰς ἔχοντι πυρώδεις. τὰ δὲ δὴ τῆς ἀκροπόλεως ἐντὸς βασιλεία κατεσκευασμένα ὧδ' ἦν. ἐν μέσῳ μὲν ἱερὸν ἅγιον αὐτόθι τῆς τε Κλειτοῦς καὶ τοῦ Ποσειδῶνος ἄβατον ἀφεῖτο, περιβόλῳ χρυσῷ περιβεβλημένον, τοῦτ' ἐν ᾧ κατ' ἀρχὰς ἐφίτυσαν καὶ ἐγέννησαν τὸ τῶν δέκα βασιλειδῶν γένος· ἔνθα καὶ κατ' ἐνιαυτὸν ἐκ πασῶν τῶν δέκα λήξεων ὥραϊα αὐτόσε ἀπετέλουν ἱερὰ ἐκείνων ἐκάστω. τοῦ δὲ Ποσειδῶνος αὐτοῦ νεὼς ἦν, σταδίου μὲν μῆκος, εὖρος δὲ τρίπλεθος, ὕψος δ' ἐπὶ τούτοις σύμμετρον ἰδεῖν, εἶδος δέ τι βαρβαρικὸν ἔχοντος. πάντα δὲ ἔξωθεν περιήλειψαν τὸν νεῶν ἀργύρῳ, πλὴν τῶν ἀκρωτηρίων, τὰ δὲ ἀκρωτήρια χρυσῷ· τὰ δ' ἐντός, τὴν μὲν ὀροφὴν ἐλεφαντίνην ἰδεῖν πᾶσαν χρυσῷ καὶ ἀργύρῳ καὶ ὀρειχάλκῳ πεποικιλμένην, τὰ δὲ ἄλλα πάντα τῶν τοίχων τε καὶ κιόνων καὶ ἐδάφους ὀρειχάλκῳ περιέλαβον. χρυσᾷ δὲ ἀγάλματα ἐνέστησαν, τὸν μὲν θεὸν ἐφ' ἄρματος ἐστῶτα ἔξ ὑποπτέρων ἵππων ἡνίοχον, αὐτόν τε ὑπὸ μεγέθους τῇ κορυφῇ τῆς ὀροφῆς ἐφαπτόμενον, Νηρηΐδας δὲ ἐπὶ δελφίνων ἑκατὸν κύκλῳ— τοσαύτας γὰρ ἐνόμιζον αὐτὰς οἱ τότε εἶναι —πολλὰ δ' ἐντὸς ἄλλα ἀγάλματα ἰδιωτῶν ἀναθήματα ἐνῆν. περὶ δὲ τὸν νεῶν ἔξωθεν εἰκόνες ἀπάντων ἔστασαν ἐκ χρυσοῦ, τῶν γυναικῶν καὶ αὐτῶν ὅσοι τῶν δέκα ἐγεγόνεσαν βασιλέων, καὶ πολλὰ ἕτερα ἀναθήματα μεγάλα τῶν τε βασιλέων καὶ ἰδιωτῶν ἔξ αὐτῆς τε τῆς πόλεως καὶ τῶν ἔξωθεν ὅσων ἐπῆρχον. ΚΡΙ. βωμός

117a

C1: They made use of both springs, the hot one and a cold one, each providing plenty of water, wondrously pleasant and excellent by nature. And they built dwellings round about and planted suitable trees. There were pools in the area, some cold and in the open air, others warm and covered over for use as baths in winter. There were separate pools for the kings, for private citizens and for women, and others for horses and the various beasts of burden, with appropriate facilities provided in each case. The overflow was channeled to the grove of Poseidon, which, because of its excellent soil, contained a

variety⁷ of lofty trees of exceptional beauty. They also channelled the water to the outer circles through pipes running along the bridges. There they had constructed many shrines to various gods, and gardens and gymnasia aplenty, some for men, some especially for horses, on each of the two circular islands. And, in particular, in the middle of the larger island there was a racing track reserved for horses, which was one stade wide and whose length was the circuit of the entire island. This space was set aside for equestrian competitions. And around the track on either side were guard houses for most of the bodyguards, although the more trustworthy among them were posted on the smaller circle, closer to the acropolis, while the most eminently trustworthy of all were allowed to reside within the acropolis, close to the kings themselves. The dockyards were full of triremes and all their necessary equipment, and everything was at the ready.

τε δὴ συνεπόμενος ἦν τὸ μέγεθος καὶ τὸ τῆς ἐργασίας ταύτη τῇ κατασκευῇ, καὶ τὰ βασίλεια κατὰ τὰ αὐτὰ πρέποντα μὲν τῷ τῆς ἀρχῆς μεγέθει, πρέποντα δὲ τῷ περὶ τὰ ἱερὰ κόσμῳ. ταῖς δὲ δὴ κρήναις, τῇ τοῦ ψυχροῦ καὶ τῇ τοῦ θερμοῦ νάματος, πλῆθος μὲν ἄφθονον ἐχούσαις, ἡδονῇ δὲ καὶ ἀρετῇ τῶν ὕδατων πρὸς ἐκατέρου τὴν χρῆσιν θαυμαστοῦ πεφυκότες, ἐχρῶντο περιστήσαντες οἰκοδομήσεις καὶ δένδρων φυτεύσεις πρεπούσας ὕδασι, δεξαμενάς τε αὖ τὰς μὲν ὑπαιθρίους, τὰς δὲ χειμερινὰς τοῖς θερμοῖς λουτροῖς ὑποστέγους περιτιθέντες, χωρὶς μὲν βασιλικάς, χωρὶς δὲ ἰδιωτικές, ἔτι δὲ γυναιξὶν ἄλλας καὶ ἐτέρας ἵπποις καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ὑποζυγίοις, τὸ πρόσφορον τῆς κοσμήσεως ἐκάστοις ἀπονέμοντες. τὸ δὲ ἀπορρέον ἦγον ἐπὶ τὸ τοῦ Ποσειδῶνος ἄλσος, δένδρα παντοδαπὰ κάλλος ὕψος τε δαιμόνιον ὑπ' ἀρετῆς τῆς γῆς ἔχοντα, καὶ ἐπὶ τοὺς ἕξω κύκλους δι' ὀχετῶν κατὰ τὰς γεφύρας ἐπωχέτευν· οὗ δὴ πολλὰ μὲν ἱερὰ καὶ πολλῶν θεῶν, πολλοὶ δὲ κῆποι καὶ πολλὰ γυμνάσια ἐκεχειρούργητο, τὰ μὲν ἀνδρῶν, τὰ δὲ ἵππων χωρὶς ἐν ἐκατέρᾳ τῇ τῶν τροχῶν νήσῳ, τά τε ἄλλα καὶ κατὰ μέσσην τὴν μεῖζω τῶν νήσων ἐξηρημένος ἵππόδρομος ἦν αὐτοῖς, σταδίου τὸ πλάτος ἔχων, τὸ δὲ μήκος περὶ τὸν κύκλον ὅλον ἀφεῖτο εἰς ἄμιλλαν

τοῖς ἵπποις, δορυφορικαὶ δὲ περὶ αὐτὸν ἔνθεν τε καὶ ἔνθεν οἰκῆσεις ἦσαν

117d

C1: That is how the residence of the kings was arranged. But beyond the three harbours, outside them, was a circular wall beginning from the sea, everywhere fifty stades distant from the largest circle and its harbours, circling back to the same place where the mouth of the canal opened to the sea. The wall was densely populated with large numbers of houses, while the canal and the largest harbour was full of ships and traders arriving from all quarters, so many that they produced a fantastic commotion and din, day and night.

τῷ πλήθει τῶν δορυφόρων· τοῖς δὲ πιστοτέροις ἐν τῷ μικροτέρῳ τροχῷ καὶ πρὸς τῆς ἀκροπόλεως μᾶλλον ὄντι διετέτακτο ἡ φρουρά, τοῖς δὲ πάντων διαφέρουσιν πρὸς πίστιν ἐντὸς τῆς ἀκροπόλεως περὶ τοὺς βασιλέας αὐτοὺς ἦσαν οἰκῆσεις δεδομέναι. τὰ δὲ νεώρια τριήρων μεστὰ ἦν καὶ σκευῶν ὅσα τριήρεσιν προσήκει, πάντα δὲ ἐξηρτυμένα ἱκανῶς. καὶ τὰ μὲν δὴ περὶ τὴν τῶν βασιλέων οἴκησιν οὕτω κατεσκευάστο· διαβάντι δὲ τοὺς λιμένας ἔξω τρεῖς ὄντας ἀρξάμενον ἀπὸ

117e

C1: Well, I have now given a fairly good report of the city and the environs of the ancient dwelling place as recounted then. I should now attempt to recall the nature and arrangement of the rest of the region. Firstly, the place was said to be elevated, with sheer cliffs rising out of the sea, while the entire area surrounding the city was a plain enclosing the city, itself enclosed by a ring of mountains stretching as far as the sea. The plain was level and smooth, elongated throughout, three thousand stades in one direction and two thousand stades inland from the sea at its centre. This particular section of the entire island was south-facing and was sheltered from the north winds.

τῆς θαλάττης ἦειν ἐν κύκλῳ τεῖχος, πεντήκοντα σταδίου τοῦ μεγίστου τροχοῦ τε καὶ λιμένος ἀπέχον πανταχῇ, καὶ συνέκλειεν εἰς ταῦτ' ὃν πρὸς

τὸ τῆς διώρυχος στόμα τὸ πρὸς θαλάττης. τοῦτο δὴ πᾶν συνωκεῖτο μὲν ὑπὸ πολλῶν καὶ πυκνῶν οἰκήσεων, ὁ δὲ ἀνάπλους καὶ ὁ μέγιστος λιμὴν ἔγεμεν πλοίων καὶ ἐμπόρων ἀφικνουμένων πάντοθεν, φωνὴν καὶ θόρυβον παντοδαπὸν κτύπον τε μεθ' ἡμέραν καὶ διὰ νυκτὸς ὑπὸ πλήθους παρεχομένων. ΚΡΙ. τὸ μὲν οὖν ἄστει καὶ τὸ περὶ τὴν ἀρχαίαν οἴκησιν σχεδὸν ὡς τότε ἑλέχθη νῦν διεμνημόνευται τῆς δ' ἄλλης χώρας ὡς ἡ φύσις εἶχεν καὶ τὸ τῆς διακοσμήσεως εἶδος, ἀπομνημονεῦσαι πειρατέον. πρῶτον μὲν οὖν ὁ τόπος ἅπας ἐλέγετο σφόδρα τε ὑψηλὸς καὶ ἀπότομος ἐκ θαλάττης, τὸ δὲ περὶ τὴν πόλιν πᾶν πεδίον, ἐκείνην μὲν περιέχον, αὐτὸ δὲ κύκλῳ περιεχόμενον ὄρεσιν μέχρι πρὸς τὴν θάλατταν καθειμένοις, λεῖον καὶ ὁμαλές, πρόμηκες δὲ πᾶν, ἐπὶ μὲν θάτερα τρισηλίων σταδίων, κατὰ δὲ μέσον ἀπὸ θαλάττης ἄνω δισχιλίων.

118b

CI: The mountains around the city were lauded at the time for their number, size and beauty, surpassing anything we have nowadays. In the mountains there were many prosperous villages with local populations, and rivers, lakes and meadows that could adequately support all the domesticated and wild animals, and an abundant variety of timber, more than enough for each and every function. Now, the plain, by nature, and because it had been cultivated by many kings over many years, had the following characteristics. It was originally four-sided, oblong, and for the most part a rectangle, but whatever it lacked in this respect they corrected by digging a trench around it. As for the depth, width and length of the trench, it is incredible to relate how any work of human hands could be so vast when compared with our usual endeavours, but I must tell you what I heard in any case. It was excavated to a depth of one plethron and it was everywhere one stade wide, while its length, running around the entire plain, was a thousand stades. It received the waters that flowed down from the mountains as it encircled the plain, and arriving at the city from both directions, it was set on its course out to the sea. Further inland from the city, one-hundred-foot-wide straight channels were cut across the

plain, emptying again into the trench on the seaward side. Each of the channels stood a hundred stades apart from the other. These were used to transport wood from the mountains down to the city, and for conveying the rest of the seasonal produce in ships by cutting cross-channels sideways, connecting the channels to one another and to the city. They took two crops from the land each year, relying upon the rains sent by Zeus in the winter, and in summer upon whatever the earth produced when they irrigated it from the channels.

ὁ δὲ τόπος οὗτος ὅλης τῆς νήσου πρὸς νότον ἐτέτραπτο, ἀπὸ τῶν ἄρκτων κατάβορος. τὰ δὲ περὶ αὐτὸν ὄρη τότε ὑμνεῖτο πλῆθος καὶ μέγεθος καὶ κάλλος παρὰ πάντα τὰ νῦν ὄντα γεγονέναι, πολλὰς μὲν κώμας καὶ πλουσίας περιοίκων ἐν ἑαυτοῖς ἔχοντα, ποταμούς δὲ καὶ λίμνας καὶ λειμῶνας τροφὴν τοῖς πᾶσιν ἡμέροις καὶ ἀγρίοις ἱκανὴν θρέμμασιν, ὕλην δὲ καὶ πλήθει καὶ γένεσι ποικίλην σύμπασιν τε τοῖς ἔργοις καὶ πρὸς ἕκαστα ἄφθονον. ὧδε οὖν τὸ πεδῖον φύσει καὶ ὑπὸ βασιλέων πολλῶν ἐν πολλῷ χρόνῳ διεπεπόνητο. τετράγωνον μὲν αὐτὸ ὑπῆρχεν τὰ πλεῖστ' ὀρθὸν καὶ πρόμηκες, ὅτι δὲ ἐνέλειπε, κατηύθυντο τάφρου κύκλῳ περιορυθείσης· τὸ δὲ βάθος καὶ πλάτος τό τε μήκος αὐτῆς ἄπιστον μὲν λεχθέν, ὥς χειροποίητον ἔργον, πρὸς τοῖς ἄλλοις διαπονήμασι τοσοῦτον εἶναι, ῥητέον δὲ ὅ γε ἠκούσαμεν· πλέθρου μὲν γὰρ βάθος ὀρώρυκτο, τὸ δὲ πλάτος ἀπάντη σταδίου, περὶ δὲ πᾶν τὸ πεδῖον ὀρυχθεῖσα συνέβαινεν εἶναι τὸ μήκος σταδίων μυρίων. τὰ δ' ἐκ τῶν ὀρῶν καταβαίνοντα ὑποδεχομένη ῥεύματα καὶ περὶ τὸ πεδῖον κυκλωθεῖσα, πρὸς τὴν πόλιν ἔνθεν τε καὶ ἔνθεν ἀφικομένη, ταύτῃ πρὸς θάλατταν μεθεῖτο ἐκρεῖν. ἄνωθεν δὲ ἀπ' αὐτῆς τὸ πλάτος μάλιστα ἑκατὸν ποδῶν διώρυχες εὐθεῖαι τετμημέναι κατὰ τὸ πεδῖον πάλιν εἰς τὴν τάφρον τὴν πρὸς θαλάττης ἀφεῖντο, ἑτέρα δὲ ἀφ' ἑτέρας αὐτῶν σταδίους ἑκατὸν ἀπεῖχεν· ἥ δὲ τὴν τε ἐκ τῶν ὀρῶν ὕλην κατήγον εἰς τὸ ἄστυ καὶ τᾶλλα δὲ ὠραῖα πλοίοις κατεκομίζοντο, διάπλους ἐκ τῶν διωρύχων εἰς ἀλλήλας τε πλαγίας καὶ πρὸς τὴν πόλιν τεμόντες. καὶ δις δὴ τοῦ ἐνιαυτοῦ τὴν γῆν ἐκαρποῦντο, χειμῶνος μὲν τοῖς ἐκ Διὸς ὕδασι χρώμενοι, θέρους δὲ ὅσα γῆ φέρει τὰ ἐκ τῶν διωρύχων ἐπάγοντες

νάματα. ΚΡΙ. πλήθος δέ, τῶν μὲν ἐν τῷ πεδίῳ χρησίμων πρὸς πόλεμον ἀνδρῶν ἐτέτακτο τὸν

119a

C1: Out of the total number of men on the plain fit to bear arms, it was decreed that each lot was to provide one leader. The size of a lot was ten stades by ten, and the total number of lots was sixty thousand. From the mountains and the region in general, there was, according to reports, an enormous number of people, all assigned on the basis of their localities and villages, to these lots and their leaders. Each leader was directed, for military purposes, to provide one-sixth portion of a war chariot for a thousand chariots, two horses with riders, a team of two horses without a chariot-board, including a fighter with a light shield and a driver for the pair of horses who was to remain with them, two hoplites and two archers and slingers, three light-armed stone-throwers and the same number of javelin-throwers, and four sailors for the ships whose full fleet numbered twelve hundred. So this is how the military equipment of the royal city was organised. The various arrangements of the other nine cities would take too long to recount.

κλήρον ἕκαστον παρέχειν ἄνδρα ἡγεμόνα, τὸ δὲ τοῦ κλήρου μέγεθος εἰς δέκα δεκάκις ἦν στάδια, μυριάδες δὲ συμπάντων τῶν κλήρων ἦσαν ἕξ· τῶν δ' ἐκ τῶν ὀρῶν καὶ τῆς ἄλλης χώρας ἀπέραντος μὲν ἀριθμὸς ἀνθρώπων ἐλέγετο, κατὰ δὲ τόπους καὶ κώμας εἰς τούτους τοὺς κλήρους πρὸς τοὺς ἡγεμόνας ἅπαντες διενενέμηντο. τὸν οὖν ἡγεμόνα ἦν τεταγμένον εἰς τὸν πόλεμον παρέχειν ἕκτον μὲν ἄρματος πολεμιστηρίου μόριον εἰς μύρια ἄρματα, ἵππους δὲ δύο καὶ

119b

C1: The distribution of positions of authority and of honour was, from the very beginning, as follows. Each one of the ten kings had authority over the people and most of the laws in his own region and his own city, punishing and executing whomsoever he wished. Their authority over one another and their communal affairs were subject to the edicts of Poseidon, which the law transmitted to them, as did the inscriptions

of the first kings written on a pillar of orichalc placed on the central island in the sanctuary of Poseidon. There they gathered every fifth year or every sixth year, alternately, thus showing equal respect for the odd and the even portion. When they met they deliberated about their communal affairs, enquired into any transgressions by any of them, and passed judgement. When they were about to deliver their judgement, they first gave pledges to one another as follows. There were bulls roaming free in the sanctuary of Poseidon. The ten kings, being present on their own, prayed that the god would select a sacrificial victim that was pleasing to himself. They then hunted with ropes and with wooden weapons containing no iron, and whatever bull they captured they brought to the pillar and cut its throat over the top of the pillar, drenching the inscription with blood.

ἀναβάτας, ἔτι δὲ συνωρίδα χωρὶς δίφρου καταβάτην τε μικράσπιδα καὶ τὸν ἀμφοῖν μετ' ἐπιβάτην τοῖν ἵπποιν ἡνίοχον ἔχουσαν, ὅπλιντας δὲ δύο καὶ τοξότας σφενδονήτας τε ἐκατέρους δύο, γυμνήτας δὲ λιθοβόλους καὶ ἀκοντιστὰς τρεῖς ἐκατέρους, ναύτας δὲ τέτταρας εἰς πλήρωμα διακοσίων καὶ χιλίων νεῶν. τὰ μὲν οὖν πολεμιστήρια οὕτω διετέτακτο τῆς βασιλικῆς πόλεως, τῶν δὲ ἐννέα ἄλλα ἄλλως, ἃ μακρὸς ἂν χρόνος εἴη λέγειν. τὰ δὲ τῶν ἀρχῶν καὶ τιμῶν ὧδ' εἶχεν ἐξ ἀρχῆς διακοσμηθέντα. τῶν δέκα βασιλέων εἷς ἕκαστος ἐν μὲν τῷ καθ' αὐτὸν μέρει κατὰ τὴν αὐτοῦ πόλιν τῶν ἀνδρῶν καὶ τῶν πλείστων νόμων ἤρχεν, κολάζων καὶ ἀποκτείνους ὄντιν' ἐθελήσειεν· ἡ δὲ ἐν ἀλλήλοις ἀρχὴ καὶ κοινωνία κατὰ ἐπιστολὰς ἦν τὰς τοῦ Ποσειδῶνος, ὡς ὁ νόμος αὐτοῖς παρέδωκεν καὶ γράμματα ὑπὸ τῶν πρώτων ἐν στήλῃ γεγραμμένα ὀρειχαλκίνῃ, ἣ κατὰ μέσην τὴν νῆσον ἔκειτ' ἐν ἱερῷ Ποσειδῶνος, οἳ δὴ δι' ἐνιαυτοῦ πέμπτου, τοτὲ δὲ ἐναλλάξ ἔκτου, συνελέγοντο, τῷ τε ἀρτίῳ καὶ τῷ περιττῷ μέρος ἴσον ἀπονέμοντες, συλλεγόμενοι δὲ περὶ τε τῶν κοινῶν ἐβουλευόντο καὶ ἐξήταζον εἴ τίς τι παραβαίνει, καὶ ἐδίκάζον. ὅτε δὲ δικάζειν μέλλοιεν, πίστεις ἀλλήλοις τοιάσδε ἐδίδοσαν πρότερον. ἀφέντων ὄντων ταύρων ἐν τῷ τοῦ Ποσειδῶνος ἱερῷ, μόνοι γιγνώμενοι δέκα ὄντες, ἐπευξάμενοι τῷ θεῷ τὸ κεχαρισμένον αὐτῷ θῦμα εἶναι, ἄνευ σιδήρου ζύλοις καὶ βρόχοις

ἐθήρευνον, ὃν δὲ ἔλοιεν τῶν ταύρων, πρὸς τὴν στήλην προσαγόντες κατὰ κορυφὴν αὐτῆς ἔσφαττον κατὰ τῶν γραμμάτων. ἐν δὲ τῇ στήλῃ πρὸς τοῖς νόμοις ὄρκος ἦν μεγάλας ἀρὰς ἐπευχόμενος τοῖς ἀπειθοῦσιν. ΚΡΙ. ὅτ' οὖν κατὰ τοὺς

120a

C1: Now, inscribed on the pillar, in addition to the laws, was an oath calling down mighty curses upon those who disobeyed. So when they had sacrificed in accordance with their own laws, they would dedicate all parts of the bull, and having blended a mixing bowl of wine, they threw in a clot of blood on behalf of each of them, and then having first cleansed the pillar, they poured the rest of the blood into the sacrificial fire. After this, they drew off some wine into golden vessels and made a libation over the fire, swearing an oath to judge in accordance with the laws inscribed upon the pillar, to punish anyone who had previously been a transgressor, and, furthermore, never intentionally to transgress any of the ordinances nor to exercise or submit to authority, save in accordance with the laws of their father. Having sworn all this on his own behalf and on behalf of their succeeding generations, each of them drank and offered up their vessel in the sanctuary of the god. Then, having spent their time engaging in the banquet and any necessary transactions, they all, once darkness had fallen, robed themselves in the most beautiful purple raiment, sat upon the ground by the embers of the ritual fire, and by night, with all fires in the sanctuary extinguished, they delivered and submitted themselves to judgement, if any of them accused the other of any transgression. When the light returned, they inscribed these on a tablet of gold and dedicated this along with their robes as a memorial.

αὐτῶν νόμους θύσαντες καθαγίζοιεν πάντα τοῦ ταύρου τὰ μέλη, κρατῆρα κεράσαντες ὑπὲρ ἐκάστου θρόμβον ἐνέβαλλον αἵματος, τὸ δ' ἄλλ' εἰς τὸ πῦρ ἔφερον, περικαθήραντες τὴν στήλην· μετὰ δὲ τοῦτο χρυσαῖς φιάλαις ἐκ τοῦ κρατήρος ἀρυτόμενοι, κατὰ τοῦ πυρὸς σπένδοντες ἐπώμνυσαν δικάσειν τε κατὰ τοὺς ἐν τῇ στήλῃ νόμους καὶ κολάσειν εἴ τις τι πρότερον παραβεβηκῶς εἴη, τό τε αὖ μετὰ τοῦτο

μηδὲν τῶν γραμμάτων ἐκόντες παραβήσεσθαι, μηδὲ ἄρξιν μηδὲ ἄρχοντι πείσεσθαι πλὴν κατὰ τοὺς τοῦ πατρὸς ἐπιτάττοντι νόμους. ταῦτα ἐπευξάμενος ἕκαστος αὐτῶν αὐτῷ καὶ τῷ ἀφ' αὐτοῦ γένει, πίων καὶ ἀναθεὶς τὴν φιάλην εἰς τὸ ἱερὸν τοῦ θεοῦ, περὶ τὸ δεῖπνον καὶ τὰναγκαῖα διατρίψας, ἐπειδὴ γίγνοιτο σκοτός καὶ τὸ πῦρ ἐψυγμένον τὸ περὶ τὰ θύματα εἶη, πάντες οὕτως ἐνδύντες ὅτι καλλίστην κυανῇν στολὴν, ἐπὶ τὰ τῶν ὀρκωμοσίων καύματα χαμαὶ καθίζοντες, νύκτωρ, πᾶν τὸ περὶ τὸ ἱερὸν ἀποσβεννύντες πῦρ, ἐδικάζοντό τε καὶ ἐδίκαζον εἴ τις τι παραβαίνειν αὐτῶν αἰτιῶτό τινα· δικάσαντες δέ, τὰ δικασθέντα, ἐπειδὴ φῶς γένοιτο, ἐν χρυσῷ πίνακι γράψαντες μετὰ τῶν στολῶν μνημεῖα ἀνετίθεσαν. νόμοι δὲ πολλοὶ μὲν ἄλλοι περὶ τὰ γέρα τῶν βασιλέων ἐκάστων ἦσαν ἴδιοι, τὰ δὲ μέγιστα, μήτε ποτὲ ὅπλα ἐπ' ἀλλήλους οἴσειν βοηθήσειν τε πάντας, ἂν πού τις αὐτῶν ἐν τινὶ πόλει τὸ βασιλικὸν καταλύειν ἐπιχειρῇ γένος, κοινῇ

120d

C1: Now, although there were many other particular laws concerning the rights of the several kings, the most important were that they should never bear arms against one another; that they would all provide assistance if anyone tried to overthrow the royal family in any city; that in accordance with tradition they would deliberate together on military issues and general concerns, granting leadership to the house of Atlas; and that the king was to have no authority to put a kinsman to death without the agreement of half of the ten. Such was the nature and the extent of the power in those regions at the time. The god, however, arrayed this power and set it against our region, and the motive for this was said to be as follows.

δέ, καθάπερ οἱ πρόσθεν, βουλευόμενοι τὰ δόξαντα περὶ πολέμου καὶ τῶν ἄλλων πράξεων, ἡγεμονίαν ἀποδιδόντες τῷ Ἀτλαντικῷ γένει. θανάτου δὲ τὸν βασιλέα τῶν συγγενῶν μηδενοῦς εἶναι κύριον, ὃν ἂν μὴ τῶν δέκα τοῖς ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν δοκῇ. ταύτην δὲ τοσαύτην καὶ τοιαύτην δύναμιν ἐν ἐκείνοις τότε οὔσαν τοῖς τόποις ὁ θεὸς ἐπὶ τούτῳ αὖ τοὺς τόπους συντάξας ἐκόμισεν ἕκ τινος τοιαύτου, ὡς λόγος, προφάσεως.

120e

CI: For many generations, as long as the nature of the god held sway in them, they were obedient to the laws and lovingly disposed towards their kindred god. For their thoughts were true and universal, dealing with one another and life's chance events with wisdom and humility. So they despised everything apart from excellence, thought little of their possessions, and easily bore their heap of gold and other acquisitions as if it were a light burden. They were not drunk on luxury, nor did they flounder because their wealth robbed them of self-control. Being sober-minded, they clearly saw that through communal love accompanied by excellence, all these material goods increase, but the more seriously we take them and the more we honour them, the more do they diminish, while excellence perishes along with them. So, based upon such reasoning as this, and with the persistence of their divine nature, all the wealth we previously described increased. But once the divine portion within them became faded by being mixed again and again with much mortality, their human character became dominant, they were unable to bear their possessions, their behaviour deteriorated, and to those with eyes to see they were an obvious disgrace for they had destroyed their most sublime and precious of possessions. But to those who were unable to see what, in truth, constitutes a happy life, these people seemed, at this stage, to represent the very pinnacle of goodness and happiness, despite being infected with unjust ambition and power.

ἐπὶ πολλὰς μὲν γενεάς, μέχρι περ ἢ τοῦ θεοῦ φύσις αὐτοῖς ἐξήρκει, κατήκοοί τε ἦσαν τῶν νόμων καὶ πρὸς τὸ συγγενὲς θεῖον φιλοφρόνως εἶχον· KPI. τὰ γὰρ φρονήματα ἀληθινὰ καὶ πάντα μεγάλα ἐκέκτειντο, πραότητι μετὰ φρονήσεως πρὸς τε τὰς ἀεὶ συμβαινούσας τύχας καὶ πρὸς ἀλλήλους χρώμενοι, διὸ πλὴν ἀρετῆς πάντα ὑπερορῶντες μικρὰ ἡγοῦντο τὰ παρόντα καὶ ῥαδίως ἔφερον οἷον ἄχθος τὸν τοῦ χρυσοῦ τε καὶ τῶν ἄλλων κτημάτων ὄγκον, ἀλλ' οὐ μεθύοντες ὑπὸ τρυφῆς διὰ πλοῦτον ἀκράτορες αὐτῶν ὄντες ἐσφάλλοντο, νήφοντες δὲ ὁζὺ καθεώρων ὅτι καὶ ταῦτα πάντα ἐκ φιλίας τῆς κοινῆς μετ' ἀρετῆς αὐξάνεται, τῇ δὲ τούτων σπουδῇ καὶ τιμῇ φθίνει ταῦτά τε αὐτὰ κάκεινη

συναπόλλυται τούτοις, ἐκ δὴ λογισμοῦ τε τοιούτου καὶ φύσεως θείας παραμενούσης πάντ' αὐτοῖς ηὔξηθη ἅ πρὶν διήλθομεν. ἐπεὶ δ' ἡ τοῦ θεοῦ μὲν μοῖρα ἐξίτηλος ἐγίγνετο ἐν αὐτοῖς πολλῶ τῷ θνητῷ καὶ

121b

C1: Zeus, god of gods, who exercises his kingship through laws, since he was able to view such matters with clarity, recognised the wretched plight of this fair race, and decided that they should meet with justice to chasten them and make them more orderly. So he gathered all the gods together in their most hallowed dwelling-place, situated at the very centre of the universe with a clear view of the entire realm of becoming, and, having assembled them, he said...

πολλάκις ἀνακραννυμένα, τὸ δὲ ἀνθρώπινον ἦθος ἐπεκράτει, τότε ἤδη τὰ παρόντα φέρειν ἀδυνατοῦντες ἡσχημόνουν, καὶ τῷ δυναμένῳ μὲν ὁρᾶν αἰσχροὶ κατεφαίνοντο, τὰ κάλλιστα ἀπὸ τῶν τιμιωτάτων ἀπολλύντες, τοῖς δὲ ἀδυνατοῦσιν ἀληθινὸν πρὸς εὐδαιμονίαν βίον ὁρᾶν τότε δὴ μάλιστα πάγκαλοι μακάριοί τε ἐδοξάζοντο εἶναι, πλεονεξίας ἀδίκου καὶ δυνάμεως ἐμπιπλάμενοι. θεὸς δὲ ὁ θεῶν Ζεὺς ἐν νόμοις βασιλεύων, ἅτε δυνάμενος καθορᾶν τὰ τοιαῦτα, ἐννοήσας γένος ἐπιεικὲς ἀθλίως διατιθέμενον, δίκην αὐτοῖς ἐπιθεῖναι βουλευθεὶς, ἵνα γένοιτο ἐμμελέστεροι σωφρονισθέντες, συνήγειρεν θεοὺς πάντας εἰς τὴν τιμιωτάτην αὐτῶν οἴκησιν, ἥ δὴ κατὰ μέσον παντὸς τοῦ κόσμου βεβηκυῖα καθορᾷ πάντα ὅσα γενέσεως μετείληφεν, καὶ συναγείρας εἶπεν—

Notes

¹ A healing god associated with Apollo.

² The 'Pillars of Heracles' is a reference to the Straits of Gibraltar.

³ These are the names of legendary Greek kings. The first three were kings of Attica, the wider region that includes Athens; the fourth was a king of Thessaly.

⁴ Deucalion was a mythical figure associated with a cataclysmic flood, which he and his wife Pyrrha survived.

⁵ The account of Atlantis mentions three units of measure: the foot, the plethron (100 feet), and the stade (600 feet).

⁶ Modern-day Cádiz in southern Spain.

⁷ The name orichalc, which literally means 'mountain copper', refers to a precious metal of unknown variety.

⁸ Acroteria were architectural ornaments that were situated at the apex or corners of pediments.

⁹ Nereids were sea nymphs who were often depicted riding various real and imagined sea creatures.